

Personal Finances Analytics

Invest More or Live More?



Meet our protagonists — and their dilemma

This is **Kenji**, an avid gamer who also applies his problem solving skills in his role as a product manager.

And this is **Mei**, a sound designer who brings music into all aspects of her life.

They're a couple **stuck in a common money debate**. One wants to invest more for the future, while the other wants to enjoy life today.

Neither is wrong — they just need a plan that makes room for both.



So how do they make room for both?

Apply [Conscious Spending Plan*](#) framework and allocate take-home pay:

Type	Description	% Take-Home Pay
Fixed Costs	What you need to live on a month (rent, utilities, groceries, transportation)	50 - 60%
Savings	Money you're going to use in 1 to 5 years (emergency fund, vacation, car)	5 - 10%
Investments	Wealth building (TFSA, RRSP, non-registered accounts)	5 - 10%
Guilt-Free	What you love to do (travel, eating out, clothes, hobbies)	20 - 35%

And here are some of their objectives:



1. Enjoy Life

- Can we afford these groceries?
- Can we book a VR session this weekend?



2. Achieve Goals

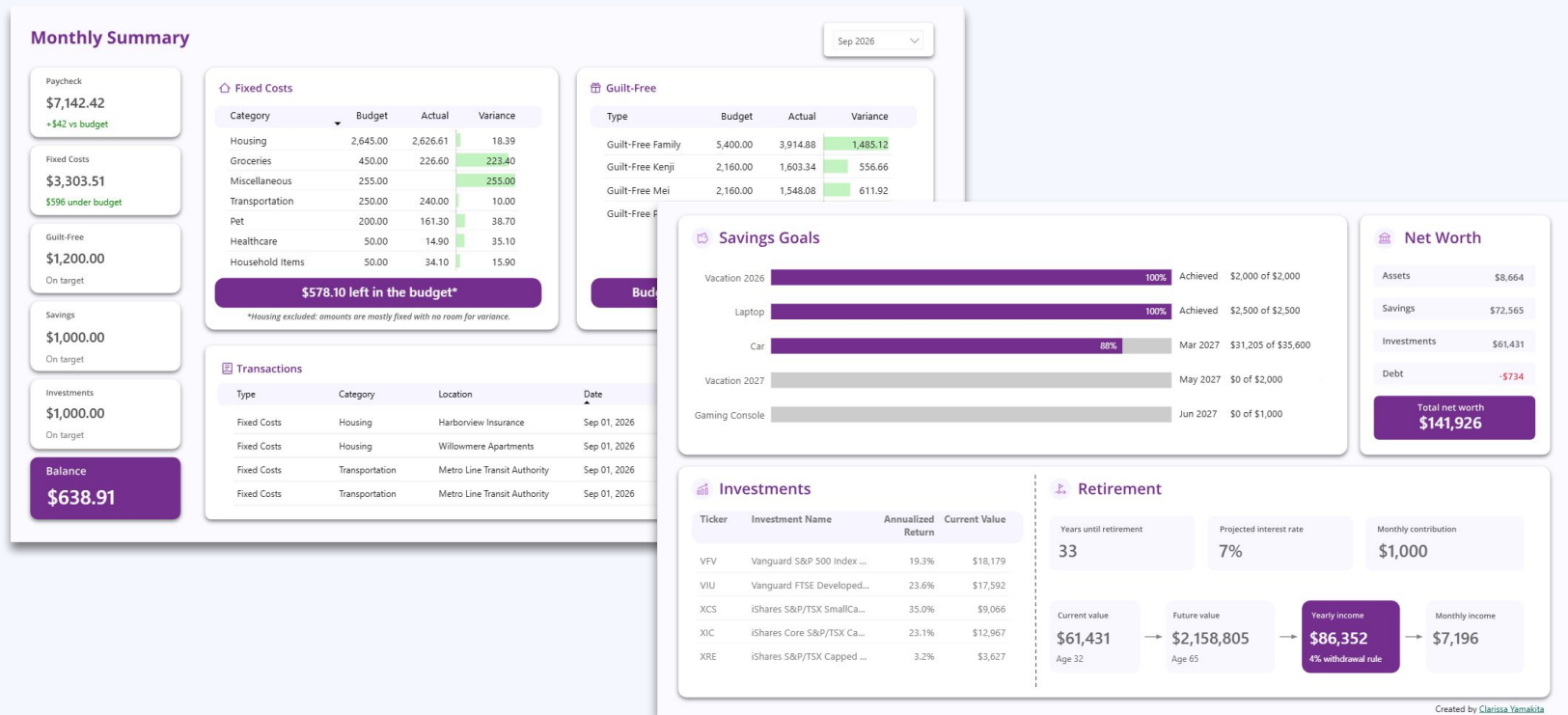
- Which goals are already funded?
- When will we be able to buy a car?



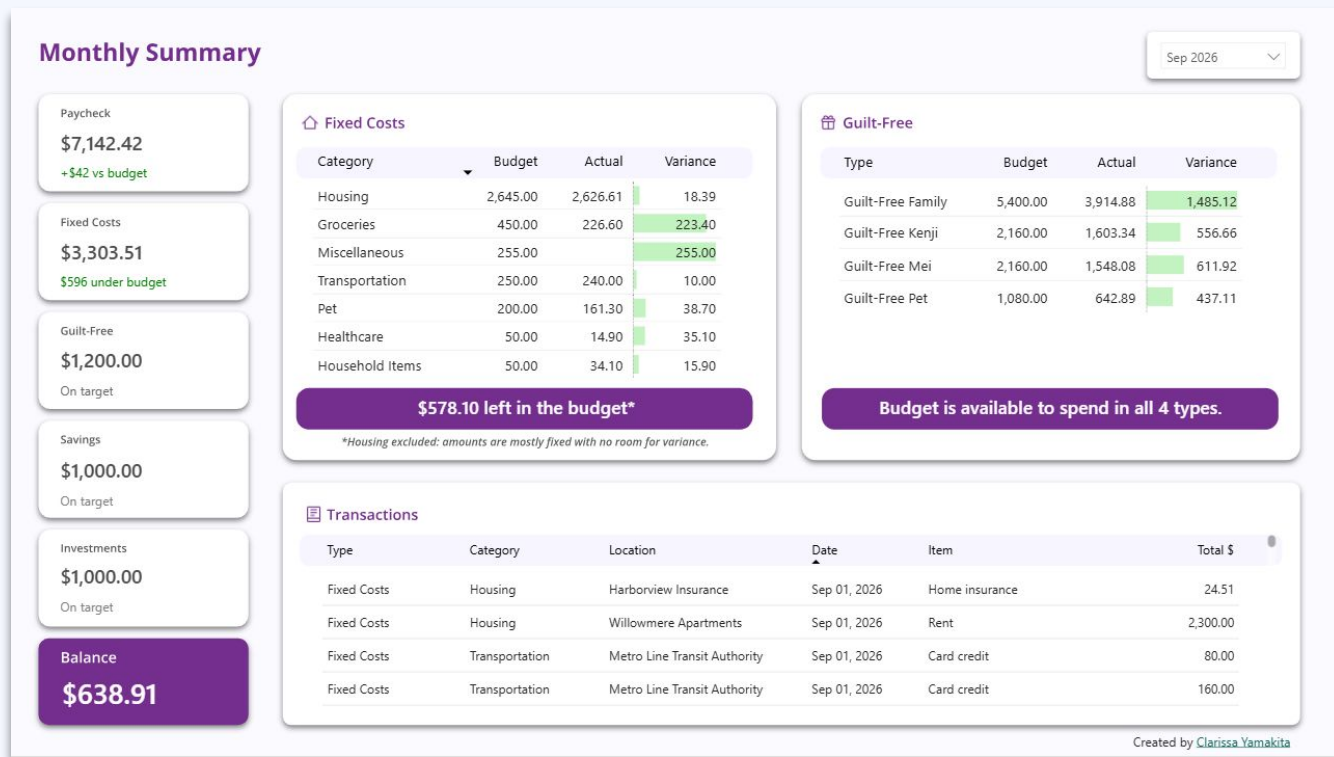
3. Build Wealth

- Will we be able to retire at 65?
- What will be our income once we retire?

How can they make sure they're on the right track?



They can use this part of the dashboard to ...



1. Enjoy Life: Can we afford these groceries?

Fixed Costs

Category	Budget	Actual	Variance
Housing	2,645.00	2,620.82	24.18
Groceries	450.00	459.57	-9.57
Miscellaneous	255.00		255.00
Transportation	250.00	240.00	10.00
Pet	200.00	134.67	65.33
Healthcare	50.00	23.49	26.51
Household Items	50.00		50.00

\$397.27 left in the budget*

**Housing excluded: amounts are mostly fixed with no room for variance.*

It depends. Even though they've already gone over the Groceries budget for this month, they still have some left from other categories, like Miscellaneous.



Specific categories could be negative **as long as they compensate for each other**. Overall variance should remain **positive**.

1. Enjoy Life: Can we book a VR session this weekend?

📁 Guilt-Free

Type	Budget	Actual	Variance
Guilt-Free Family	600.00	575.74	24.26
Guilt-Free Kenji	240.00	153.74	86.26
Guilt-Free Mei	240.00	228.29	11.71
Guilt-Free Pet	120.00	30.59	89.41

Two types have less than \$50 remaining to spend.

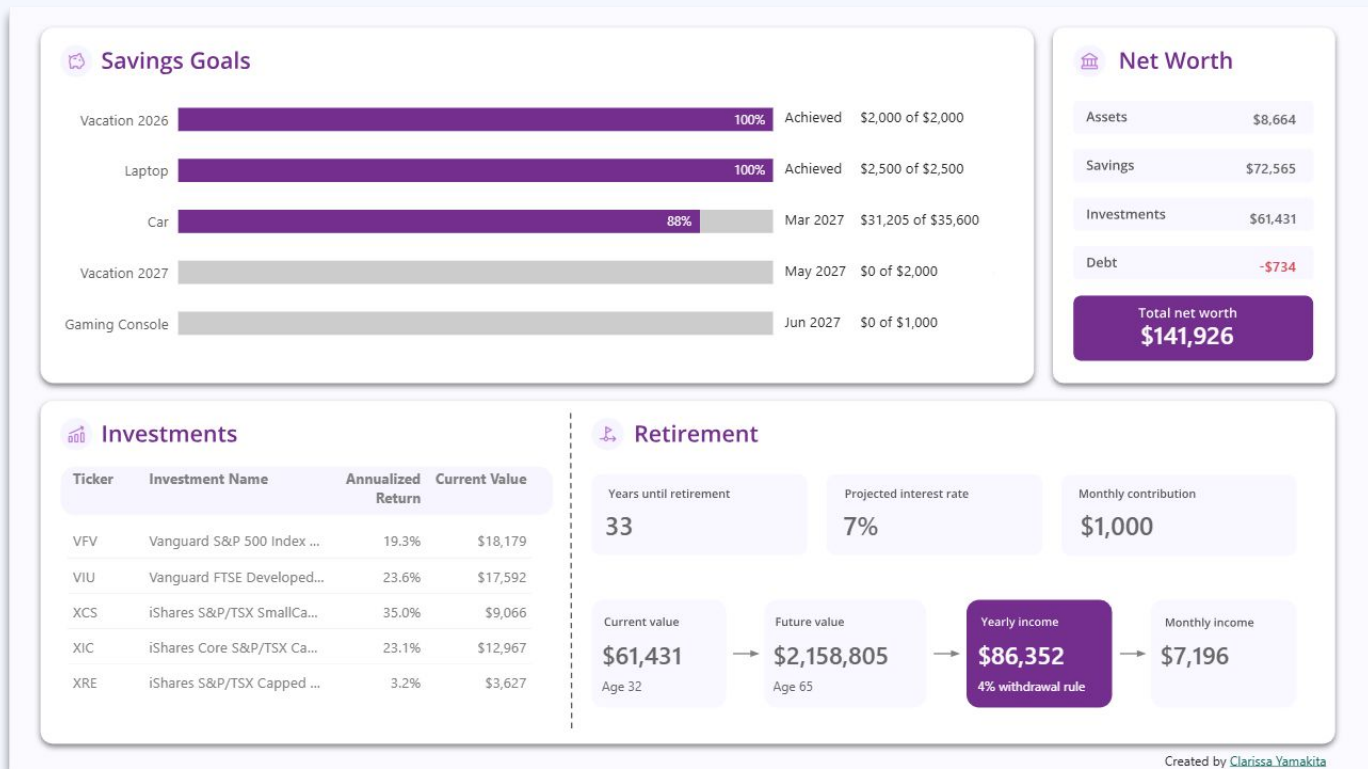
Amounts are **accumulated** over time. If a certain amount isn't used on a month, it can be **carried over** to the future.

A VR gaming session for 2 people + dinner with friends could cost around \$200 in total.

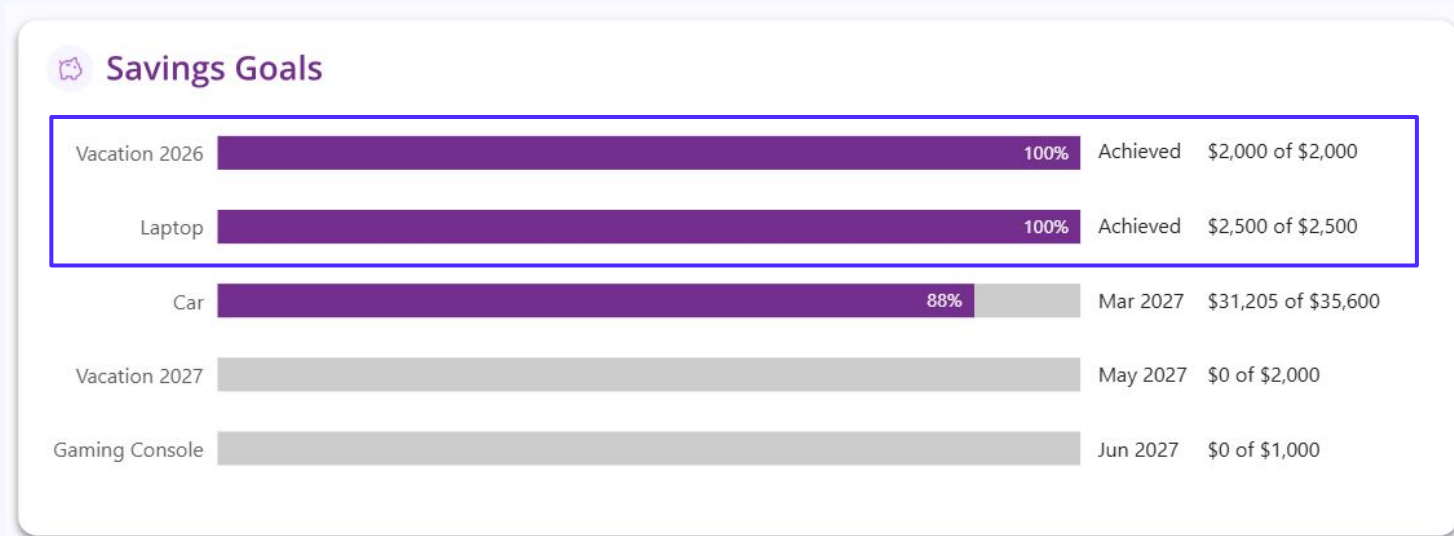
Kenji and Mei don't have enough on their Guilt-Free Family budget this month.



And here is where they see their dreams coming true:

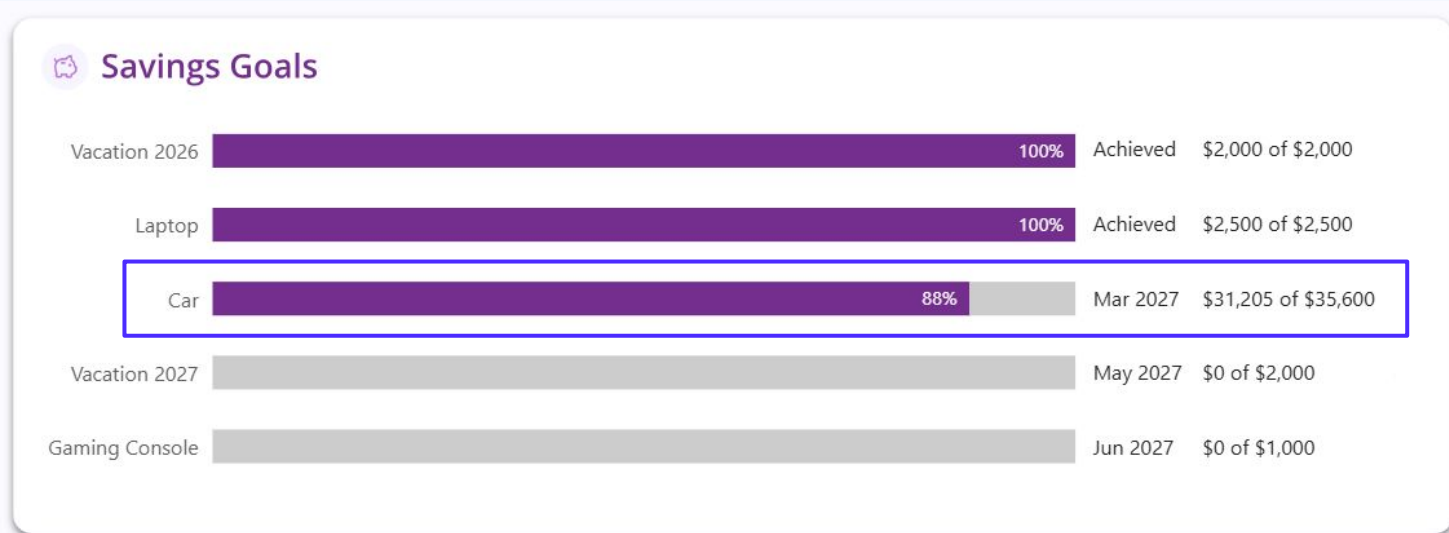


2. Achieve Goals: Which goals are already funded?



Kenji and Mei have already saved the amount needed for this year's vacation and a laptop.

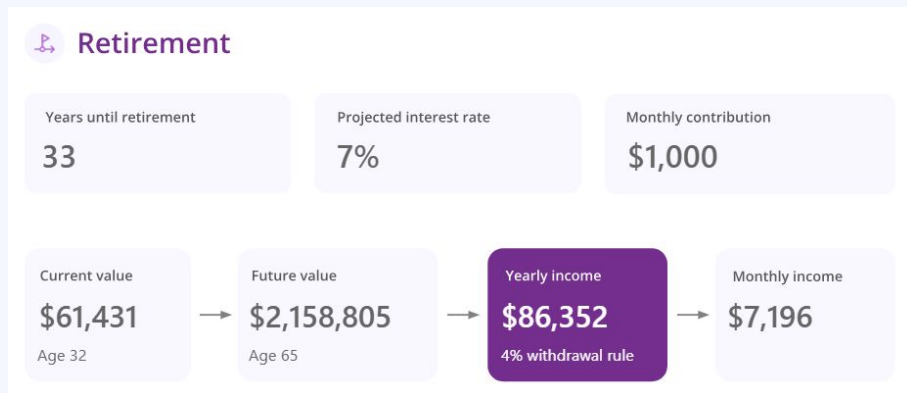
2. Achieve Goals: When will we be able to buy a car?



With their current savings progress, they should be able to buy a car by March, 2027.



3. Build Wealth: Will we be able to retire at 65?

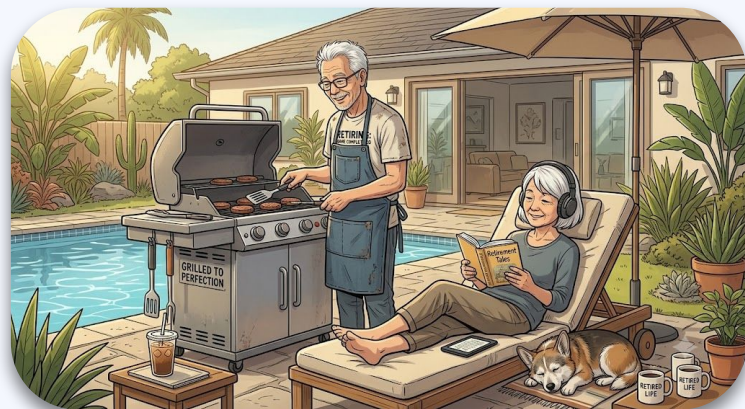
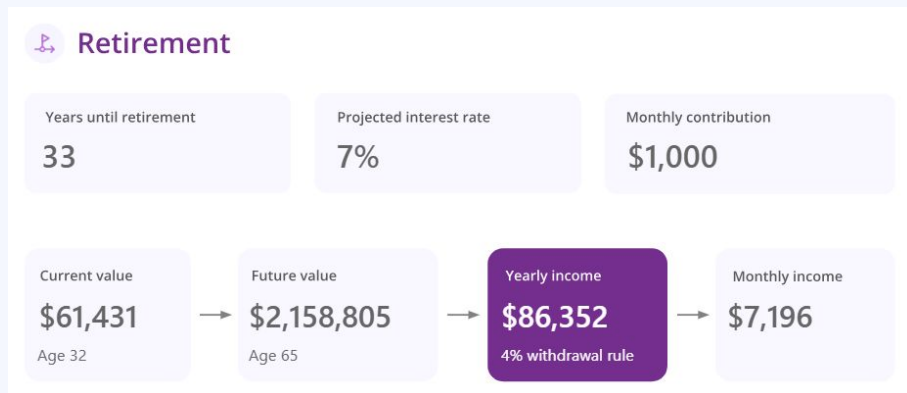


In **33 years**, Kenji and Mei could have enough to live off only from their investments.

They would have about **\$2.1M** considering an average interest rate of 7% and a monthly contribution of \$1,000 to their current investments.

The **4% withdrawal rule** says you can safely withdraw about 4% of your portfolio per year without running out of money — that's how **\$2.1M** becomes **\$86K/year**.

3. Build Wealth: What will be our income once we retire?



Good news: their gross monthly income would be about \$7.2K — close to Kenji's and Mei's current paycheck of \$7.1K.

The exact take-home pay will depend on how they withdraw from their accounts, but the numbers point to a comfortable retirement without giving up the life they enjoy today.

Turns out, they don't have to choose ...

Because their plan makes room for enjoying life today and a comfortable retirement.

